Evidence Cards · *Sheet 1*

✂ A helper (not the host) cuts these out and sorts them into three envelopes: Appetizers, Main Course, Pie.

EVIDENCE #1 — APPETIZERS

Goldie's Run-of-Show Card

Taped inside the pantry door, in Goldie's handwriting: "5:30 Fill MY boat from the pot. Warming shelf, under my napkin. NOBODY touches it! 5:58 Fetch boat. 6:00 sharp: first taste at the head table. After dinner: THE NEWS."

EVIDENCE #2 — APPETIZERS

Avery's Barn Map

The welcome-table map of Juniper Barn. The kitchen opens onto the main hall. The pantry sits between the kitchen (swinging door) and the mudroom (back door, with Avery's note: "latch sticks and clacks, sorry!"). The mudroom holds the coat hooks, the side door to the orchard lot and the only ladder to the hayloft.

EVIDENCE #3 — APPETIZERS

The Stuffing Label

A folded label beside Casey Thornbury's mushroom stuffing: "WILD mushrooms, lovingly foraged by me! C." Several guests have quietly scraped their spoonful back into the dish.

EVIDENCE #4 — APPETIZERS

Goldie's Speech Card

In Goldie's apron pocket, a card in her handwriting: "Friends, after ten years our little book is growing up. I've said YES to Harvest Hill Publishing. They'll own The Juniper Barn Cookbook, every recipe and the name, and there will be a TV show too. Before I sign, every penny gets counted."

EVIDENCE #5 — MAIN COURSE

Dr. Linden's Note

From the doctor who came up the lane: "Goldie took a large dose of crushed sleeping tablets with the gravy from her silver boat. The gravy pot on the stove is fine, and no mushrooms or other dishes played any part. The tablets were stirred in after the gravy was poured into the boat."

EVIDENCE #6 — MAIN COURSE

Muddy Prints

Boot prints on the mudroom floor run from the orchard side door to the coat hooks and straight back out. The rain stopped at 5:15, so they were made later. No prints go near the pantry door or the ladder.

Evidence Cards · *Sheet 2*

✂ A helper (not the host) cuts these out and sorts them into three envelopes: Appetizers, Main Course, Pie.

EVIDENCE #7 — MAIN COURSE

Casey's Porch Video

Casey's camera, front porch, 5:44 to 5:53. Casey narrates; Jules waves throughout. At 5:47 Quinn carries a cider jug up the steps and inside. Through the front window, Goldie rehearses at the head table and Quinn pours cider beside her until the clip ends.

EVIDENCE #8 — MAIN COURSE

Jules's Coat

On the third hook in the mudroom hangs Jules Carraway's coat. Its pocket holds a pharmacy receipt for sleeping tablets, dated last week. There are no tablets in the coat.

EVIDENCE #9 — PIE

The Bottle in the Hay

Pushed deep into a hay bale in the hayloft: an empty pharmacy bottle labeled "J. Carraway, sleeping tablets," wiped clean and wrapped in a page torn from the cookbook proofs. The page is covered in red-pencil corrections.

EVIDENCE #10 — PIE

The Sealed Proofs

In Goldie's tote bag: a padded envelope from Harvest Hill Publishing, still sealed. The label reads: "Cookbook proofs, copy 1 of 2. Copy 2 sent to the editor, Morgan Feld."

EVIDENCE #11 — PIE

The Recipe Box Note

Tucked behind the gravy card in Goldie's recipe box: "Royalty statement is $3,600 short. Three years! M. has until the announcement to tell everyone. Then I will."

EVIDENCE #12 — PIE

The Blue Ribbon

In Goldie's apron: last year's blue ribbon from the county pie contest, pinned to a maple pecan pie recipe card in Goldie's grandmother's handwriting. A sticky note reads: "Word for word! Sage, we need to talk."

Card Backs

Print this page on the back of pages 1 and 2 so your helper can cut the cards face down.











